The Papers Behind the Medicaid Question

Where Mom's deed, insurance policies and account records are, and who holds them.

The deed might be in the safe deposit box. The life insurance policy is somewhere in Mom's desk. Your brother has a folder he's been meaning to bring over.

This page doesn't ask you to understand any of these papers, or to work out what they mean for Medicaid. It asks where each one is, how recent it is, and who has it.

WHAT TO COLLECT	WHERE IT IS	ITS DATE	WHO HAS IT
The deed to Mom's home			
A current property tax bill, and any mortgage or home loan statement			
A recent statement for each account, showing the names on it			
The deed or title for anything Mom owns with someone else			
Trust documents, if there is a trust			
Annuity contracts, with a recent statement for each			
Life insurance policies			
Any paperwork from a gift, a transfer or a change in ownership			
What the hospital, the rehab or the facility has written about the care Mom needs			
Papers that show where Mom lives and her citizenship or immigration status			
Anything in writing you've been given about Medicaid: a handout, a letter, a note from the business office			

What's missing, and who will look for it

Anything above with an empty line. Put a name next to each.

FOR EXAMPLE No copy of the deed. David will check the safe deposit box on Saturday. Nobody has the annuity contract; Karen will call the company and ask for a copy.

How to use it

- Write the date printed on each paper. If it has no date, write “undated.”
- Where a paper shows more than one name, copy the names exactly as they appear. Don't work out what they mean.
- Don't rewrite or summarize a document here. Just say where it is.
- Bring this page and the papers to your conversation with your Medicaid planner.

What this page doesn't do

It doesn't explain what any deed, policy, trust or statement means, and it doesn't say which of them matter for Mom's situation. Medicaid rules vary by state, so that is a question for your Medicaid planner, and for an elder law attorney where a legal document is involved. Nothing here is legal, financial or tax advice.

Ready for the next step?

You know which papers you have, where each one is, and which ones you still have to find. The planning interview uses what you've collected: it asks about your family's situation and gives you a free planning report to bring, along with the papers, to any conversation about paying for care.

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WHERE THIS COMES FROM

The rows about the home follow the papers the Administration for Community Living says a state may ask a homeowner for. The rest come from the Medicaid Planning Roadmap's working list for this step.

1. Administration for Community Living (LongTermCare information), Applying for Medicaid